

BRIAN ALEXANDER

West Hollywood, CA | 310-890-9435

briankendallalexander@outlook.com

[Website](#) | [LinkedIn](#)

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior entertainment legal executive with 20+ years of experience operating at the intersection of content, dealmaking, and enterprise execution across film, television, and multi-platform media. Proven leader in building and scaling content businesses within complex organizations, driving cross-functional alignment across development, production, finance, and distribution. Proven operator and trusted C-suite advisor who owns every stage of the content lifecycle while structuring and closing high-value, multi-party agreements; designing and managing greenlight approval workflows; and leading alignment across all corporate stakeholders. Deep command of deal architecture across rights-holders, studios, global streamers, networks, and producers. Track record of driving deal velocity while maintaining rigorous risk discipline. Known for bringing structure without bureaucracy and enabling creative teams to operate with both discipline and agility. Admitted to the California State Bar.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Deal Structuring, Negotiation & Legal Drafting • Rights, Development, Production, Co-Production & Distribution Agreements • Greenlight Process Design • Financial Modeling • IP Rights Strategy & Catalog Exploitation Above-the-Line Talent (Writers, Directors, Producers, Artists, Estates) • Global Content Licensing (Theatrical, SVOD, AVOD, FAST, Digital) • Option / Rights Acquisition & Chain of Title • First-Look Arrangements • Multi-Party Music Rights & IP Coordination • Guild Compliance • Cross-Functional Team Leadership & Process Infrastructure • Risk Assessment & Mitigation

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

SVP, Business & Legal Affairs, Universal Music Group | Santa Monica, CA | 2017 - 2025

Senior executive responsible for operational and transactional leadership across UMG's film and television business (primarily through its Polygram Entertainment division), overseeing development, production, financing, and distribution activities across multiple business units. Functioned as a central partner to creative, finance, and corporate leadership, helping to scale the company's content operations and align strategy with execution. Promoted from VP to SVP in 2019.

- Helped build and operationalize UMG's film and television business within a global music company, establishing workflows across development, production and distribution.
- Owned end-to-end deal process for UMG's visual media portfolio, from initial concept through greenlight, production, and distribution. Managing high-volume deal flow across scripted, unscripted, documentary, and animated content simultaneously.
- Designed and led the greenlight approval process, authoring deal approval memos securing greenlight sign-off from corporate leadership on projects representing tens of millions in committed production spend.
- Served as lead deal architect on multiple complex multi-party deals for Polygram Entertainment, coordinating IP and music rights across UMe (catalog), UMPG (publishing), production, and distributors to unlock *award-winning* projects built around UMG artists.
- Negotiated and drafted development, production, co-production, financing, rights acquisition, services, licensing, and distribution agreements with major studios, SVOD streamers, broadcasters, estates, artists and above-the-line talent representatives.
- Structured licenses, co-production agreements, and first-look arrangements with global partners including Netflix, Amazon, Lionsgate TV, Apple TV+, HBO, Disney, Sony, NBC, and MGM.
- Translated UMG's recorded music and publishing catalog assets into film, television, and digital content partnerships, advising executive leadership on long-term IP exploitation and content value across all platforms.
- Acted as cross-company connector between music, film, television, and corporate stakeholders to unlock new content partnerships and drive catalog monetization.

Selected Projects: The Bee Gees: How Can You Mend a Broken Heart (HBO); The Beastie Boys Story (Apple TV+); Stax: Soulsville USA (HBO); Zoey's Extraordinary Playlist (NBC); Selena y Los Dinos (Netflix); Noah Kahan: Out of Body (Netflix); Paul McCartney: Man on the Run (Amazon); The Greatest / Ali (Amazon limited series); Bob Marley Animated Feature (Disney); Ozzy & Sharon Love Story (Sony); Fight the Power (MGM)

Director, Business & Legal Affairs, Discovery Communications | Los Angeles, CA | 2015 – 2017

Senior dealmaker supporting TLC's unscripted and lifestyle programming portfolio.

- Led negotiations for talent, production, and co-production agreements across domestic and international unscripted series, maintaining deal standards and throughput across a high-volume slate.
- Partnered with network leadership on franchise strategy, rights management, IP licensing, and brand extensions.
- Pioneered exclusivity and digital carve-out provisions for talent with social media influence, anticipating the evolving SVOD and AVOD landscape before it became industry standard.

Vice President, Business & Legal Affairs, Viacom (Paramount) | Los Angeles, CA | 2011 – 2014

- Led deal negotiations and legal drafting for original series, specials, and content acquisitions across multiple Viacom networks including Spike and VH1.
- Supported programming, development, and production teams through all phases of greenlight and delivery.
- Evolved unscripted deal structures for multi-platform distribution, emerging digital outlets, and SVOD licensing.
- Managed above-the-line and below-the-line talent deals and maintained guild compliance across the slate.

Head of Production Legal, Magical Elves, Inc. | Hollywood, CA | 2009 – 2011

- Led the company's production legal function during a period of rapid growth.
- Negotiated all series and format agreements with major U.S. networks and platforms, including Emmy-winning Top Chef and multiple spinoffs.
- Structured and negotiated branded entertainment, trade-out, and sponsorship integration agreements, pioneering organic integration models that delivered value to brand partners, productions, and networks simultaneously.

Director, Business & Legal Affairs, Discovery Communications | Los Angeles, CA | 2005 – 2008

- Negotiated talent, production, and rights agreements across a broad unscripted programming slate while ensuring guild compliance and managing risk exposure.

COMMUNITY & BOARD SERVICE

Court Appointed Special Advocate (CASA) — Volunteer advocate supporting youth in the foster care and the LA County juvenile court system.

Outfest — Former board member supporting LGBTQ+ filmmakers and independent storytelling.

EDUCATION

Juris Doctor (J.D.), with Honors — Florida State University College of Law

Editor, Journal of Land Use and Environmental Law

Bachelor of Arts (B.A.), English Literature — Florida State University

BAR ADMISSION

California State Bar — Active Member